

# KF Facilitator Guide

## Chapter 10: Morbid Dependency<sup>1</sup>

---

1:10 Weekly/1:10 Weekend Intensive (WI)

Facilitator: “Welcome everyone to the session 10 of the KF *Neurosis and Human Growth* book study. Let’s go to Presenting. Please just give your name and location. I will begin.”

“My name is \_\_\_\_\_. I am calling from \_\_\_\_\_.”

- Each facilitator makes a list of the names of students as they present.
- Each facilitator asks, “Is there anyone who hasn’t been able to fill out their reading guide?”
- Assign the first 10 questions, 5 questions each to two students. While students read, plan the student assignments for the next set of questions.

Question 11 is an open question.

1:15/1:15 WI

1. Which is the least satisfactory among the three neurotic solutions? (239.1)  
**The self-effacing solution.**
2. Why do self-effacing people feel miserable more often and more intensely than others? (239.1)  
**Because of the many functions that suffering has assumed for them.**
3. What lures this type as the supreme fulfillment? (239.3)  
**Love**  
Not only sexual love, but all kinds of love or finding identity in someone else.  
  
Rather than finding autonomy, they move from relationship to relationship.
4. What does love seem to promise for these people? (240.1)  
**Protection, support, affection, encouragement, sympathy, understanding, feeling of worth, meaning to their life, salvation and redemption.**
5. What is the appeal of love for the typical self-effacing person? (240.2)  
**Loving and being loved.**
6. What two deep and powerful sources feed the longing for love? (240.2)
  - A. **The longing for surrender**  
They want to lose themselves and surrender to something bigger than they are.
  - B. **The longing for unity**  
They want to become one heart and one flesh with another person, to find the unity they cannot find in themselves.

7. Self-effacing people have a propensity to do what? (240.2)

**To lose themselves in all kinds of feelings.**

Feelings can also become the substitute for real spiritual connection. Christian worship services and praise teams might actively stir up strong feelings, which the self-effacing person might mistake for worship.

Feelings become the definition of reality:

- “If I feel like you hurt me, then you actually had malicious intent against me.”
- “If I don’t feel like you love me, then you do not love me.”
- “I feel depressed; therefore, I must be living the wrong life.”

They often exaggerate in their imagination the assault they sense from others or from life in order to explain or justify the extent and severity of their feelings.

“I feel, therefore I am.”

8. Love also appears to this type as the only way to do what? (241.2)

**To actualize the idealized self.**

In partnering (immersing oneself) with the other, they hope that the other will bring them to glory. They want the partner to do the expansive work that will make their idealized self actual. This can work out in marriages where one spouse insists that the other do the difficult spiritual work, lead the marriage to happiness, and fight all the battles with the world while they reap the benefits.

9. What ranks first among the factors determining the self-effacing person’s self-evaluation? (241.3)

**Lovableness.**

10. What does rejection mean for self-effacing people? (241.3)

**Rejection means losing all the hopes that they have attached to somebody, and it leaves them with a feeling of utter worthlessness.**

This makes it essential to find some kind of resolution with the person who rejected them so that a sense of their own worth can be restored. Self-effacing people often demand apologies from others even when others have no sense of doing wrong. They must cling to a sense of “rightness” and “good intentions” to hold together the rages of their pride-system. Getting some kind of satisfying resolution then becomes an obsession because without resolution their sense of value is gone.

1:20/1:20 WI

11. Which of these shoulds or claims do you recognize in yourself or others? (241.4–242.1)

**Open this question to the group.**

- I should not only be sympathetic but be the absolute in understanding
- I should never feel personal hurts because of my understanding nature; to feel hurt would be petty or selfish
- I should never be jealous
- I should be more serene, forgiving, thoughtful than those around me
- Externalized shoulds: I should always measure up to the expectations of others
- I should be able to create a perfect relationship with another person
- I am entitled to exclusive devotion and the fulfillment of my needs

- I am entitled to be loved for my attentiveness, my weakness and helplessness, my suffering, my self-sacrifice, and my good intentions

12. In what other relationships may the dynamics of morbid dependency occur? (243.2)

**Nonsexual friendships.**

Parent/child, teacher/pupil, doctor/patient, leader/follower, therapist/client, employer/employee, mentor/disciple, friendships.

Dependency may be rationalized as loyalty or obligation.

13. Instead of actually choosing a partner, self-effacing people are what? (243.3)

**They are “spellbound” by certain types.**

This is why mastery types get bored with self-effacing types. Self-effacing types have no courageous thoughts of their own.

Resigned types will feel suffocated by self-effacing types who demand way too much emotional enmeshment.

How do you protect yourself from becoming spellbound? By the courageous development of your own life, ideas, and mission.

14. What specifically accounts for this type’s fascination with expansive types? (244.2)

**The suppression of their expansive drives.**

If they suppress their expansive drives, then they need someone else to fulfill those drives for them.

15. What allows self-effacing people to participate in the mastery of life? (244.2)

**Loving a proud person, merging with them, and living vicariously through them.**

16. In what two factors does this type’s magnetic attraction to expansive types lie? (246.1)

- The fascination that arrogance and aggressiveness in others exert on the self-effacing person**
- The self-effacing person’s own need for surrender**

17. What is the first characteristic of the self-effacing partner in a morbidly dependent relationship? (247.2)

**Total absorption in the relationship.**

The self-effacing person is still egocentric however. Their neurotic egocentricity compels them to do whatever it takes to keep the other person around them. All their own interests subside except their interest in maintaining a sense of absorption.

18. At bottom what are both partners feeling when they clash on the issue of “love”? (248.3–249.1)

**Self-righteous.**

19. How does the fluctuating process that leads into more and more conflicts begin? (251.2)

**It begins with helplessness toward aggressive people.**

They have lots of stories about how strong others are and how helpless they are in comparison.

20. When pride has been broken, this type's compliance is determined by what longing? (251.3)

**A longing for total surrender.**

1:30/1:30 WI

21. The need for total surrender makes what necessary? (252.2)

**It is necessary to idealize the partner** – or the friend, teacher, boss, etc.

They exaggerate the other's positive qualities and dismiss the negative and then use the imagination to fill in areas that don't exist.

The partner is no longer a real person to discover, but a figment of the self-effacing person's imagination. This can be very frustrating for the other person in the relationship.

22. How do self-effacing types try to improve a relationship? (253.2)

**They try to please, to measure up to the other's expectations, to see the fault in themselves, to overlook and not resent, to understand, to smooth over.**

It is difficult for the self-effacing type to see the reality of how they participate in the problem. They manufacture virtue stories about how forgiving and accommodating they are and refuse to recognize the realities of their choices.

Their efforts to please and willingness to take the blame makes it unnecessary for others in the relationship to examine themselves.

Although self-effacing types are always ready to take the blame, they feel resentful about the conflict because they secretly do not accept real responsibility for their part in creating it. They demand that someone understand them as much as they imagine they are understanding of others. Often what they claim to understand about you or themselves stems from the virtue story of their intention to be understanding.

The neurotic problem is that no amount of understanding satisfies them for long. Their need for understanding is insatiable.

23. What emotion may become conscious in flashes, and what trends come to the fore? (253.3)

**Hatred becomes conscious in flashes and vindictive trends come to the fore.**

24. Although the longing to gain the partner's love persists, it becomes more strongly a matter of what? (254.1)

**Vindictive triumph.**

Making the other come crawling is now a matter of needing triumph to restore pride and, also, to restore worth through the other's admission of wrong.

25. What are morbidly dependent people unable to do if their pride is satisfied? (254.2)

**Love.**

The need to restore pride outweighs the need to love and be loved.

26. Why is this type driven to be tormented and humiliated? (255.1)

**Because they hate and despise themselves.**

Abuse from someone else may have some reference to reality, but since the self-hate feelings are so strong, the stories of abuse are exaggerated to explain those feelings.

1:35/1:35 WI

27. Ultimately, for the morbidly dependent type, what does the partner become? (255.1)

**The partner becomes the executor of the self-effacing person's own self-destruction.**

Self-effacing types need to feel abused in order to keep up the shrinking victim story. They don't realize how much they are inviting the abuse.

A KF member worked hard on herself and found that her reactions to her self-effacing mother were becoming healthier. Then she noticed how her mother actively invited abuse. Even if she responded to her mother with kindness, her mother reacted to the kindness as if someone had slapped her. This was so frustrating for the KF member that it took all of her KF training to refuse the invitation to actually slap her mother!

A self-effacing child may aggravate a parent/teacher into punishing them because they are looking for someone to execute punishment for their imagined shortcomings. Watch for this same tendency in your children. Use your KF tools to help the child recognize what is really going on and learn to self-care.

28. Which process is eminently painful for this type? (257.2)

**The process of struggling out.**

Self-effacing types need compassion, support, and guidance. The intense suffering that self-effacing neurotics experience tends to motivate this type to seek therapeutic help. This is why KF attracts more self-effacing neurotics than expansive or resigned types. Self-effacing people are not afraid of the difficult work because their whole life is difficult. Sometimes they hope that KF will help them be more successful at getting love, support, and the fulfillment of their glorious dreams. When they realize that their KF work work is about their own real development and not about finding a magical way to continue their search for glory, they often leave the program.

29. What can go far toward helping self-effacing neurotics attain a measure of inner freedom? (258.1)

- **The mobilization of sufficient constructive forces**
- **Maturing enough through real suffering**
- **Plain ordinary honesty with themselves**
- **Their efforts to get on their own feet**

This is why KF training often produces successful results for the self-effacing type. KF helps them mobilize their constructive forces. KF tools help them be honest.

30. The passionate character of the involvement cannot exist without what expectation? (258.3)

**The expectation of some vital fulfillment.**

The self-effacing type is looking for someone else or some other cause to give them a sense of fulfillment. They will not learn how to find it in themselves because finding fulfillment in themselves would be expansive and conflict with their dream of losing themselves by merging with another.

When their best neurotic efforts cannot attract the care they crave, they can start to unravel. The unravelling of our self-effacing lives can be a productive moment of change that leads to developing real self-care.

### 31. What drives the morbidly dependent type? (258.3)

**The drive for total surrender and the longing to find unity through merging with the partner.**

When those around the self-effacing type notice the effort the self-effacing person is making toward change, they may attack or withdraw to try to drive the self-effacing person back into their role of subservient victim. That can really scare a self-effacing type into giving up. But if the self-effacing person has had sufficient training and support, they can begin to feel the joy of standing on their own feet. With support, they can learn to stand against the pressures that are trying to force them back into their victim role. Sometimes the self-effacing type starts feeling their anger for the first time, and they are not skilled in handling it, which might scare those around them. With training, however, they can use their anger productively for harmonious self-assertion and the maintenance of healthy boundaries.

1:45/1:45 WI

All the groups return to the main group for discussion.

**Facilitator of weekly groups:** “Next week will be the last week of our study. The Weekend Intensive NHG study will be available this coming weekend and will give you an opportunity to make up any meetings and homework that you have missed. Look at the NHG schedule on the website to find the times of the chapters you wish to make up in order to meet the prerequisites for KF training. We finish this study with the KF Introductory Meeting. This gives you the opportunity to attend a real meeting in real time and see if KF training is for you. You can find the date, time, and access code for this meeting on the website. Thank you everyone for showing up and doing this difficult work. Goodbye everyone.”

**Facilitator of Weekend Intensive:** “Session 11 will be our last session of the study. We finish the NHG Book study with a KF Introductory Meeting. This gives you the opportunity to attend a real meeting in real time and see if KF training is for you. You can find the date, times, and access code for this meeting on the website.”

Lead Facilitator: Dismiss the students and stop the recording. (\*9 then 1)

All facilitators, please stay after the meeting to confirm student attendance and homework completion on the [NHG Attendance Spreadsheet](#).

Lead Facilitator: “Are there any comments or questions?”

---

<sup>1</sup> This reading guide refers to the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle Toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney, published by W.W. Norton and Company Inc. New York.